VERIFICA CITTADINANZA E COSTITUZIONE INGLESE

The HISTORY OF INTERNATIONAL WOMAN'S DAY

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March 8th

20th century = Periodon with several changes

1 woman's day celebration = Chicago May 3rd 1908 → organized by the US Socialist Party

1500 women who demanded political and economical equality

At the International Women's Conference, that preceded the general meeting of the Socialist Second International in Copenhagen in August 1910 leading German socialists Wise Zietz and Clara Zetkin → proposed an establishment of an annual International Woman's Day as a strategy to promote equal rights (including suffrage for women)

→ Clara pushed for establishing an international women's day

Socialists had argued that women's liberation would only materialize under socialism

Feminism was seen as a cause for middle- and upper class women w/ their own class interests in mind

March 18th 1911 (40th anniversary of the Paris Commune) → International women's day was marked for the first time

Many women, from different nations took part in marches and meetings

→ The Austrian-Hungarian Empire alone witnessed more than 300 demonstrations → next year European continent too

WW1 → many international collaboration ended that had underpinned International Women's Day

→ deep division among the socialists women

- some supported nationalist sentiments
- others were against the war and worked for working-class unity

and many other women
Clara Zetkin and abandon the socialist party and embrace the Communist Parties

→ Russian women had first celebrated International Women's Day on March 8th in 1913

1917 → working class women in Saint Petersburg, exasperated by the rising prices (food) and the deterioration of living conditions, led a demonstration asking for an end to war and political autocracy "Bread and Peace"

→ March 12th Tsar Nicholas II was forced to abdicate
→ 1917 establishment of IWD in the rest of Europe
→ 1922 Lenin established the IWD as a communist holiday in the New Soviet Union
→ 1949 official holiday in China too
SPAIN → spanish communists used March 8th 1936 as the occasion to stage a huge demonstration in Madrid demanding protection of the Spanish Republic against a growing fascist threat.

→ The IWD remained a communist holiday till the end of 20th century
During the interwar years some European socialists and social democrats continued to mark "Women's Day" omitting the term "International" to distinguish it from the communist celebration

1980 this day gained importance again → European women named it as "Women's International Day of Struggle"
this name signaled political radicalism and a resolute distance from organized party ties

ing 1975 International Women's Year the United Nation first celebrated
ternational Women's Day

1977 the United Nations General Assembly adopted a resolution proclaiming a United Nations Day for women's rights and International Peace.
the assembly noted that it was to be observed "on any day of the year by member states, in accordance w/ their historical and national traditions".

March 8th is now marked in a variety of ways around the world
- in many communists regions it's a public holiday
- In western Europe it remains an occasion for feminist demonstrations
- in many developing countries women's rights activists take to the street to voice their calls for gender equality

Italy → yellow mimosas
US → cards & flowers

THE HISTORY OF THE RIGHT TO VOTE

1215 at Runnymede a charter of rights called The MAGNA CARTA was signed → it put limitations on powers of the crown for the first time

- gave barons access to justice and protection for illegal imprisonment

↓

after a rebellion against king John of England

1689 → was Established the BILL OF RIGHTS

- a standing army without permission from parliament became illegal
- levying money without permission from parliament also became illegal
- it helped establish a constitutional monarchy by limiting the reigning monarch's powers
- it confirmed the key role of the parliament

After the napoleonic wars → Manchester was suffering

HENRY HUNT organized a demonstration for democratic reform.

The process for arresting him caused the Peterloo massacre

10 → 20 deaths and 700 injured

it brought to the GREAT REFORM ACT 1832

- it was meant to prevent candidates from buying voters
- got growing towns the power of MPs and representatives they needed

↓

but the new law officially excluded women from voting! → a voter was a male

→ 1838 – 1857 = FURTHER REFORMS

- votes for the men over the age of 21

- secret ballots
- annual parliamentary elections
- no property requirement for MPs
  any man could participate in a democratic system

→ 20th century → women in London started demanding the right to vote → SUFFRAGETTES
- using direct action and civil disobedience → no matter of the cause ← punishment
  some of them died for the cause
  ↓

1928 THE REPRESENTATION OF THE PEOPLE ACT
→ gave all women over 21 the right to vote

On 28th August 1963 in Washington USA → black civil rights activists were fighting to end segregation and secure the right to vote
after years of segregation known as APARTHEID people of all races were allowed to vote and they chose NELSON MANDELA as their first black president in 1994

THE HISTORY OF THE INTERNATIONAL WOMEN'S DAY

1907 → The international conference of socialist women had gathered in Stuttgart Germany → led by Clara Zetkin
German Marxist from the German Social Democratic Party
the asked for gender equality at work

→ 1st women's day declared by the socialist party and the women's committee in US → protests for → better working conditions
↳ better pay
↑ 28th of February 1909

during the meeting of the socialist second international August 1910 they demanded → 8 hours working day
→ that pregnant women stop working for 8 weeks prior to giving birth
→ that women would be paid "motherhood insurance" of 8 weeks if the child lived
everything by using a part of the tax revenues

→ The first European celebration of international women's day happened in Vienna → March 8th 1911
women marched around the Ringstrasse commemorating the martyrs of Paris commune and demanding the equal right to vote

1912 → Lawrence Textile Strike in US / "Bread and roses strike"
slogan by Rose Schneiderman american socialist and feminist
women not only need bread for surviving but also dignity and decent working standards (roses)

during WW1 Clara Zetkin organised the 3rd and final anti-war women's conference April 1915

1917 → most dramatic women's day celebration (Russia)
↳ led by Alexandra Kollontai

During the war the number of women working in factories raised a lot but they were paid half as much the men they replaced → mostly in textile and chemical industries
→ they protested for their mistreatement
February 23rd in Petrograd women striked - against war, starvation and the Czar → he ordered to shoot if it was necessary but the women had managed to convince whole regiments to switch sides and join them → even Trotski
he abdicated

1921 Clara Zetkin and 2nd International Conference of Communist Women in Moscow state that March 8th was the official day and Clara with Lenin made it a communist holiday in 1922
China communists started celebrate it ↳ 1951

Stalin 1936 → reversed liberal policies
→ banned abortion

THE TRIANGLE SHIRTWAIST FIRE

March 25th 1911

9th floor of the Ash building, the workers are leaving after a week of hard work (52h) making the blouse that have come to symbolise practical, independent womanhood
→ they were almost all women mostly Jews

On the 8th floor someone tosses a cigarette in a bin filled with cloth scarps and tissue paper patterns and set up a fire
→ people pile into the rickety fire escape others run to the WASHINGTON STREET STAIRCASE but it was locked
→ workers were forced to leave via the Green Street stair so they could be checked for not having stolen cloths

→ a floor manager opened the door but the fire was already every where

Noone warned the 9th floor and everything happened too fast
The flames blocked the Green Street stairs so the workers piled onto the fire escape but it collapsed making 20 people fall down
an elevator operator made as many trip as he could but the heat damaged the machine and it blocked
some women jumped down the shaft trying to slide down the cables

The firemen arrived but they could only reach the 6th floor
women began to jump out of the windows
33 of them jumped while they were already burning

146 deaths on the street mostly women (teenagers)
the youngest was 14 y.o

among the crowd watching ther was Frances Perkins of the consumers' ligue

she had been struggling for the past 4 months a factory fire in Newark that killed 25 p.

⇒ American factories needed evacuation plans!!!

- adequate fire escapes
- sprinkler system

The women who lost their life were the same that the previous year staged a strike for shorter hours, better pay and the ability to form unions

Max Blanck and Isaac Harris (factory bosses) had hired gangsters and prostitutes to assault them

they won shorter hours and higher wages

There was a marched funeral in New York and 120 000 p showed up and 300 000 p watched

Blanck and Harris were acquitted of manslaughter (assoluti dall'accusa di omicidio colposo)

The unions demanded an independent committee focused on safety reforms = Tammany Hall

but it was more used for making money through corruption and it was Tammany cops that arrested workers on the picketline and T. gangsters that broke Clem Lemuch's nbs

Perkins had received support from Al Smith, a rising Tammany star and he could probably be convinced
but when Perkins pushed for a factory investigation committee, Smith shot it down instead

THE PROBLEM WITH DEMOCRACY

if the majority of the society/nation believes in some crazy idea it may only take one election for them to ruin their society

DEMOCRACY DARK SIDE → only danger of democracy = TYRANNY of the majority if the majority of voting citizens are anti-semitic a big enough majority can often alter human rights if a charismatic leader is able to successfully scapegoat a minority group in a time of crisis]

common situation in Congo

* first woman to serve in the cabinet

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Tammany Hall → American political organization that became the main local political machine of the democratic party and played a major role in controlling NYC and New York state politics
Al Smith was an Irish catholic boss of the Tammany
Charles Murphy was the longest serving head of New York City's Tammany Hall

Murphy ordered to Smith to take a stand on Triangle and from that moment Tammany would have been the party of workers

They started the investigation and the socialist Clara Lemlich, the head of Shirtwaist Strike, was taken on as an investigator
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The got huge results in few time
10 new investigator fanned out and checked 2,000 factories in 9 cities → The triangle was not an anomaly
↳ There were no safety measure

All The commission drafted is new bill covering fire safety factory conditions and employment rules for women and children (8 of those bill became law)
- automatic sprinklers
- fire drills
- fireproof stairways

} NOW MANDATORY

The commission dissolved in 1915 w/ 36 of its bill enshrined in law → they also protected child workers, created a department of labor, founded a workman's compensation system for those injured on the job
within years NY had the strongest labor laws in the nation
Smith built the bases for a new liberal politic that another democratic, Franklin Roosevelt, would have brought to the White House
Perkins → secretary of labor *